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1

LOOKUP

The lookup function is used to search for a value in a one row or one column and return a corresponding value from another row or column

In simple words it helps us find information from a dataset

Syntax: =LOOKUP (loopup_value, lookup_vector, [result_vector])

lookup_value: The value we want to search for means it is a single value, which is provided as a reference

lookup_vector: means the lookup_value's entire row or column

result_vector: The result value which we want from entire row or column

Ex: 1

	Employee code	Employee name	City
2	1	JP Kumar	Mumbai
3	2	Anjali Thakur	Delhi
4	9	Arjun jain	Mumbai
5	13	Anupam	Mysor
6	17	Satish	Mumbai
7	20	Manish	Noida

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Here, only employee code is given we have to find out the emp name and city from the main table

=LOOKUP(J2,$A$2:$A$21,$B$2:$B$21) = Emp name
=LOOKUP(J2,$A$2:$A$21,$D$2:$D$21) = city

The lookup_value should not contain any formulas

- Disadvantage
- Lookup generally expects the loopup vector to be sorted in ascending order
- It can return an approximate match, so it may not be suitable for every-match search
- It generally requires stored data for reliable results
- It is less flexible when searching across complex datasets
- It can be confusing when the lookup and result ranges are not aligned correctly

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2 VLOOKUP

This is called as vertical lookups. It searches for a value in the first column of the table and returns a related value from another column in the same table. This looks for a value in the leftmost column of a table and then returns a value in the same row or from a column we specify. By default, the table must be sorted in an ascending order

Syntax: =VLOOKUP(lookup_value, table_array, col_index_num, [range_lookup])

table_array : the whole table
col_index_num : The column number in the selected table from which we want the result
[range_lookup] : Specifies the type of match
- FALSE - exact match (0)
- TRUE - approximate match (1)

Ex: =VLOOKup($J2, $A$2:$A$21, MATCH(K$1, $A$1:$G$1, 0), 0)

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MATCH: used to find the position of a specific value within a row or column. It returns the position number not the actual value

Syntax: =MATCH(lookup_value, lookup_array, match_type)

lookup_value: The value which we want to find

lookup_array: The lookup_value row or column where excel searches for the value

match type: the exact match or approximate match

=MATCH(K1, A1:G1, 0)

o/p = 2

Vlookup needs a column number to know which column to return. Instead of manually entering 2, 3 or 4, we use MATCH to find the column number automatically from the heading

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Disadvantage

- The lookup value must be in the first column of the selected table, and the result must be in a column to its right
- Exact match should be specified
- It returns the first matching results, not all matching records
- Repeated VLOOKUP formulas across large datasets can slow down as workbook

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